Culture of Learning Non-Negotiables

Purpose

At KIPP, we believe **all students can be successful** and that **culture and academics are intertwined** and so we must cultivate daily learning environments that center the brilliance of our students and allows them to build their knowledge, sharpen their skills by learning from their teachers and each other by establishing and maintaining enabling conditions in classrooms and common spaces that allows students to access learning. The learning environments we seek for our students can only happen with intentional planning and consistent implementation and will require investment from leaders, teachers, families, and students.

One KIPP Expectation

All KIPP High School classrooms meet the baseline expectations for the student learning experience, creating classroom cultures that are positive and productive. Schools and regions can *add* to the language of the expectations below or add additional expectations, but no item should be deleted or omitted.

To ensure that classrooms meet the expectations outlined below school and regional leaders will need to:

- Communicate the "why" behind expectations to students and staff.
- Be clear with all stakeholders on *how* to launch these expectations with students *and* how to support students in meeting each expectation through training, coaching, and practice.
- Intentionally monitor and respond to these expectations through walkthroughs and real-time coaching, survey feedback and student/teacher focus groups.
- Clearly communicate and implement consequences with consistency when expectations are not met.

KIPP High School Culture of Learning Non-Negotiables| In 100% of KIPP Classrooms…	
Teachers foster learning partnerships that build trust and rapport.[1]	• Teachers call students by their name and pronounce student names correctly. ○ Students correct teachers or other students if their name is mispronounced. • Teachers express warmth through their tone and body language (positive and enthusiastic). They do not yell, use sarcasm that intends to demean or condescend, or employ a tone/language that conveys dismissal or disregard. • Student expectations for how they should engage in all components of the lesson are clearly communicated or easily accessible (e.g. clear WTD, slides, Routines & Procedures 101, school-wide expectations)

[1] Zaretta Hammond, *Culturally Responsive Teaching & the Brain* (Corwin, 2014).

	• Students have access to all accommodations and supports (e.g. graphic organizers, manipulatives) without having to ask for them.
Teachers are prepared to teach and facilitate rigorous high-quality instruction.	• Teacher lesson plans and exemplars are available to leaders and teacher carries plan/exemplar in hand while teaching. • Students are engaged in **grade level and course appropriate** content and learning tasks.[2] • Teachers engage students in multiple ways: thinking, listening, speaking and writing.[3]
Students are actively engaged and free from distraction during all components of instruction.[4]	• No cell phones or headphones are visible or in use during instruction.[5,6] • Backpacks are in their appropriate location (e.g. no students should have backpacks on their backs or on their desks.) • All heads are off desks, and all hoods are off heads[7,8]. • Students are actively completing the learning task. • There is evidence of students following along with the speaker (e.g., eye contact, nodding, writing, and/or responding verbally (when prompted).[9]
Students are supported in meeting classroom expectations.	• Teachers insist on 100% of students meeting classroom expectations and support students in meeting expectations through positive narration, appropriate proximity, individual student check-ins, and/or a consequence.[10] • Students ask for what they need from their teachers or teammates to successfully engage in learning and demonstrate mastery of the content.

[2] https://tntp.org/publications/view/the-opportunity-myth

[3] Zaretta Hammond, *Culturally Responsive Teaching & the Brain* (Corwin, 2014).

[4] https://www.oecd-ilibrary.org/sites/f05bb3ee-en/index.html?itemId=/content/component/f05bb3ee-en

[5] Doug Lemov et. al *Reconnect: Building School Culture for Meaning, Purpose, and Belonging* (Jossey-Bass, 2023)

[6] https://www.edweek.org/leadership/cellphone-bans-can-ease-students-stress-and-anxiety-educators-say/2023/10

[7] Doug Lemov *Teach Like a Champion 3.0* (Jossey-Bass 2021)

[8] https://www.oecd-ilibrary.org/sites/f05bb3ee-en/index.html?itemId=/content/component/f05bb3ee-en

[9] Doug Lemov *Teach Like a Champion 3.0* (Jossey-Bass 2021)

[10] Doug Lemov *Teach Like a Champion 3.0* (Jossey-Bass 2021)